PERSONAL FINANCE MANAGEMENT APP

Full Product & Development Roadmap

A Tanzania-first personal finance application designed to help users track, plan, save, understand, and improve their money.

Product vision: Build more than an expense tracker — create a smart personal finance manager that can eventually become an AI-powered financial companion.

1. Core Product Idea

• Answer the user's central question: **Where is my money going, and what should I do with it?**

• Core audience: students, young adults, people with irregular income, small business owners, freelancers, and anyone who wants better control of personal finances.

2. Main App Navigation

• **Home** — financial overview and quick actions.

• **Transactions** — income, expenses, transfers, search and filters.

• **Budget** — monthly spending limits and progress.

• **Goals** — savings targets and contributions.

• **Insights** — charts, trends and financial health.

• Central **+** action for quickly adding a transaction.

3. Home Dashboard

• Show total balance, account balances, monthly income, monthly expenses, amount saved, savings rate, recent transactions, upcoming bills and budget alerts.

• Quick actions: Add Income, Add Expense, Transfer, Add Goal.

• Example: Total Balance TSh 1,245,000; Income TSh 1,500,000; Expenses TSh 850,000; Saved TSh 650,000.

4. Expense Tracking

• Categories: Food, Transport, Rent, Airtime/Data, Shopping, Beauty, Education, Entertainment, Bills and Other.

• Transaction fields: amount, category, date, account, description, payment method and optional receipt/photo.

• Example: TSh 12,000 — Food — Lunch — M-Pesa — 29 Oct 2026.

5. Income Management

• Support Salary, Business, Freelancing, Allowance, Commission, Trading, Gifts and Other.

• Display income by source and total monthly income.

6. Multiple Accounts

• Support Cash, Bank accounts, Mobile Money and Cards.

• Examples for Tanzania: M-Pesa, Airtel Money, Tigo Pesa, HaloPesa, bank and cash.

• Transfers between accounts must not be counted as income or expense.

7. Budgets

• Users set monthly limits by category.

• Show budget, amount spent, remaining amount and percentage used.

• Trigger alerts when a category approaches or exceeds its limit.

8. Savings Goals

• Users create goals such as Laptop, Emergency Fund, Tuition, Business Capital or Travel.

• Track target amount, current amount, remaining amount, progress percentage and recommended monthly contribution.

9. Recurring Payments

• Support rent, internet, subscriptions, insurance, school fees, loans and other recurring bills.

• Send reminders before due dates.

10. Debt Management

• Track loans, money borrowed, money lent, credit cards and repayments.

• Store original amount, amount paid, remaining balance, next payment and due date.

11. Analytics & Financial Health

• Monthly income vs expenses charts, spending by category, savings trends and comparison with previous months.

• Financial health score out of 100 based on saving, budgeting, debt, emergency fund and spending consistency.

• Example insight: 'Your strongest area is saving. Your biggest opportunity is reducing unnecessary shopping expenses.'

12. Emergency Fund

• Create an emergency-fund goal and estimate how many months of essential expenses the current fund could cover.

13. Calendar

• Show salaries, bills, subscriptions, loan payments and other financial events on a monthly calendar.

14. AI Money Assistant — Future Feature

• Answer questions such as 'Why am I always running out of money?' or 'Can I afford this purchase?' using the user's recorded financial data.

• Provide explanations and recommendations while clearly positioning the feature as guidance rather than guaranteed professional financial advice.

15. Security

• Email/password authentication, optional Google login, PIN/biometric protection, secure sessions, database access rules and encrypted sensitive data.

• **Never store bank passwords, ATM PINs, card PINs or mobile-money PINs.**

16. User Profile & Settings

• Profile, currency, country, financial goals, budget style, notifications, security, data export, backup, privacy and account deletion.

• Default currency can be TZS for a Tanzania-first version.

17. Reports & Export

• Allow users to export financial records as PDF, CSV and Excel.

• Monthly report should include income, expenses, savings, top categories and budget performance.

18. Recommended Technology Stack

• **Frontend:** React + Vite.

• **Backend:** Supabase.

• **Database:** PostgreSQL.

• **Authentication:** Supabase Auth.

• **Charts:** a React-compatible charting library.

• **Deployment:** a modern web hosting platform, with mobile packaging later if desired.

19. Database Structure

• **users**, **accounts**, **transactions**, **categories**, **budgets**, **budget_categories**, **savings_goals**, **goal_contributions**, **recurring_transactions**, **debts**, **debt_payments**, **notifications**, **financial_insights**.

• Transactions should contain: id, user_id, account_id, category_id, type, amount, description, transaction_date and created_at.

• Transaction type: income, expense or transfer.

20. Development Phases

• **Phase 1 — MVP:** registration/login, dashboard, income, expenses, categories, accounts, transactions and basic monthly budget.

• **Phase 2 — Strong Product:** savings goals, charts, recurring expenses, notifications, transfers, reports and search/filtering.

• **Phase 3 — Smart Product:** financial insights, spending predictions, financial health score and AI assistant.

• **Phase 4 — Professional Product:** biometric security, backup, advanced analytics, exports, multi-currency and multilingual support.

21. Monetization

• **Free:** transactions, basic budgets, basic goals and dashboard.

• **Premium:** AI assistant, advanced analytics, unlimited goals, advanced budgeting, predictions, reports and custom features.

• Potential pricing can be tested later rather than fixed before validating the market.

22. Tanzania-First Direction

• Use TZS as a primary currency and design around common local payment/account categories.

• Future bank/mobile-money integrations should only be added through appropriate APIs, partnerships, permissions and applicable regulations.

23. Long-Term Vision

• Start as an Expense Tracker → Budgeting App → Personal Finance Manager → AI Financial Assistant → broader financial ecosystem.

• Potential future integrations: banks, mobile money, savings and investments, subject to technical access, partnerships and regulatory requirements.

24. Product Build Order

• 1. Idea & requirements → 2. User flows → 3. UI/UX → 4. ERD/database design → 5. Authentication → 6. Accounts → 7. Transactions → 8. Budgets → 9. Goals → 10. Dashboard → 11. Analytics → 12. Testing → 13. Security review → 14. Deployment → 15. User feedback → 16. Premium/AI features.

MVP SCREEN MAP

Screen	Purpose
Login / Sign Up	Create and secure the user account.
Home	Balance, income, expenses, savings, alerts and quick actions.
Add Transaction	Record income, expense or transfer.
Transactions	View, search, filter and edit transactions.
Accounts	Manage bank, cash, mobile-money and card accounts.
Budget	Set category limits and monitor spending.
Goals	Create and monitor savings goals.
Insights	Charts, trends and financial health.
Profile / Settings	User preferences, security, currency and data controls.

PRODUCT PRINCIPLE

Build small first, but design the architecture for the big vision. The first release should be beautiful, reliable and genuinely useful before adding AI, financial integrations or complex features.